

Deal 1 Ctr: 7♣ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Deal 3 Ctr: 6♥ Goal: at most ____ losers



Count Fast and Slow Losers				
♠	♥	♦	♣	Total
Decide How to Reduce Losers				
Ruffs	Finesse	Pitch	Length	

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7♣

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 7 5 4 2

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q 10 4 3

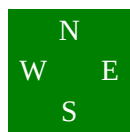
♣ 4

♠ A

♥ A 6 3

♦ K 5

♣ A K Q J 9 8 7



♠ K Q 9 6 3

♥ Q 9 8 5

♦ 9

♣ 10 6 2

♠ J 8

♥ K 7 4

♦ A J 8 7 6 2

♣ 5 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

2♣

Pass

3♦

Pass

4NT

Pass

5♦

Pass

5NT

Pass

6♦

Pass

7♣

All Pass

7♣ by North

into a Threat card against West's ♦Q.

But, the ♠J is already a Threat card against East's ♠Q.

Play your ♣J and ♣9, discarding the ♦8 and the ♥4 from dummy.

East can afford to discard the ♠9 and the ♥5.

West can spare his two ♠s.

[showcards N:SJ,HK,H7,DJ E:HJ,HT,H2,DQ S:HA,H6,H3,C8 W:SQ,HQ,H9,H8]

You are there. Play your ♣8.

East cannot throw the ♠Q, so he gives up the ♥8. Dummy's ♠J is of no further value so you dump it.

West cannot throw the ♦Q, so he gives up the ♥2.

And you take the last three tricks with the ♥ suit. There were only two defenders; one of them had to guard ♠s and the other had to guard ♦s. There was nobody left to guard ♥s.

North is to play 7♣. East leads the ♠K.

At first glance this doesn't appear to be a difficult hand. You expect to win the opening lead, pull trumps, then establish a ♦ winner by playing ♦K, ♦A, and ruffing a ♦. As long as they split 3-2 you could reach dummy's ♦ winner with the ♥K.

So you take the ♠A, pull three rounds of trumps and play ♦K.

But when you lead to the ♦A East discards a small ♠.

Time to rethink. You are in dummy now, and you can ruff a ♦, return with the ♥K and ruff another ♦. The last ♦ would be good but you'd have no way to reach it.

Think squeeze instead. Ruff a ♦. This turns the ♦J

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ Q 4
♥ J 9 7 3
♦ K 7 5
♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ 10 9 7

♥ 4

♦ Q J 9 4 2

♣ J 10 9 3



♠ -

♥ A K Q 10 5

♦ A 8 6 3

♣ A K Q 4

♠ A K J 8 6 5 3 2

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 10

♣ 7

West	North	East	South
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Pass	Pass	2♣	4♠
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6♥		5♥	Pass
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All Pass

6♥ by East

either one is going to do the same thing. Assume South wins the ♦10.

He will then play the ♠K, which you must ruff in your hand.

Now play a small ♦ to dummy's ♦K.

[showcards N:HJ,D7,C8,C6 E:DQ,DJ,CJ,CT S:DA,D8,CQ,C4 W:SJ,S8,S6,S5]

You are in dummy, ready for the squeeze.

Play dummy's ♥J.

North gets to choose his own fate - discarding a protector in one of the two suits. Of course, whichever suit he discards you will throw the opposite one.

Yet another slam, courtesy of the Squeeze Play!

East is to play 6♥. South leads the ♠A.

If ♦s and ♣s split nicely this would be an easy slam. But with that wild ♠ bid by South you can't expect decent splits.

So you ruff the ♠, pull trumps in three rounds, then play ♣A K and get the bad news when South discards a ♠.

You now know that North guards the ♣s. And since South had 3 ♥s and a very long ♠ suit it is pretty likely that North guards the ♦s also. You will try to squeeze North in ♣s and ♦s, but first you must lose a trick to rectify the count.

So you play a low ♦ from each hand.

It doesn't matter which defender takes the ♦, since